

TrendStack Nigeria Playbook

# 04 - Creator and Campaign Operations Playbook

How to vet creators, run campaigns, control payouts, reduce fraud and report results.

**Operating principle**

Do not build more software until paid demand and repeatable campaign operations are proven. Use WhatsApp, Sheets, simple forms, Drive and manual reporting first.

| Document | Purpose                                                                                                                      | Use it when                                                                                                      |
|----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 04       | A focused guide that separates strategy from execution so the founder and Nigeria team can act without information overload. | Use this as a working playbook. Review it weekly, mark what is done, and update based on paid campaign evidence. |

Version 1.0 - 17 May 2026

Inputs used: founder context, current TrendStack learnings, and the uploaded Growth Marketing Plan for Trendstack.

# 1. Creator bench strategy

TrendStack should build a campaign-ready creator bench, not a large unmanaged influencer community.

**Target creator pool**

Start with 30-50 vetted creators in Lagos across beauty, fashion, food, lifestyle, wellness and selected startup/event categories. Expand only when paid demand requires it.

| Tier             | Meaning                                                                                    | Allowed work                                                         |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| New creator      | Passed basic screen but not yet tested in a paid campaign.                                 | Fixed fee only. No performance bonus. Small campaigns only.          |
| Verified creator | Delivered at least one campaign properly with good communication and compliant content.    | Fixed fee plus small capped bonus where appropriate.                 |
| Trusted creator  | Repeated delivery, strong content quality, no suspicious performance, good brand feedback. | Higher briefs, better rates, possible capped performance incentives. |

**Do not let new creators drain campaign budgets.** New creators should earn through fixed deliverables, not unlimited view-based payouts.

## 2. Creator vetting checklist

Vetting should measure reliability, brand fit and real audience quality, not just follower count.

| Area                 | What to check                                                                              |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Identity and contact | Name, WhatsApp, city, email, social handles, payment details.                              |
| Niche clarity        | Beauty, fashion, food, lifestyle, wellness, tech/startup, campus, events.                  |
| Content quality      | Video clarity, audio, editing, storytelling, brand safety and ability to explain products. |
| Engagement quality   | Normal comments, real conversations, no obvious bot-like comment patterns.                 |
| Audience relevance   | City/location fit, age group, niche audience, platform audience overlap.                   |
| Reliability          | Response speed, ability to follow a mock brief, past client behavior if available.         |
| Fraud risk           | Suspicious spikes, repeated low-quality accounts in comments, inconsistent metrics.        |
| Rate expectation     | Fee per video, posting fee, revision expectations, product/sample needs.                   |

### Vetting score

Use a simple 1-5 score for content quality, reliability, niche fit, audience relevance and fraud risk. The first creator bench should be selected from the highest total scores.

### 3. Creator onboarding terms

Keep terms clear before any paid campaign starts.

- [ ] Creators must follow the campaign brief and disclose sponsored content where required.
- [ ] Draft content must be submitted before posting unless the campaign says otherwise.
- [ ] Creators cannot change key product claims, price claims or CTA without approval.
- [ ] Payment is released after approved posting, proof submission and minimum post-live period.
- [ ] Creators must not buy views, use bots, join engagement pods, or manipulate campaign metrics.
- [ ] Creators must provide post links, screenshots or platform analytics when requested.
- [ ] TrendStack may withhold or review payouts if fraud, non-compliance or missing proof is detected.
- [ ] Usage rights must be agreed: whether the brand can repost, edit or use the content in ads.

**Practical rule:** before complex legal documents, use a clear campaign acceptance message that creators must agree to in writing on WhatsApp or form submission.

## 4. Campaign execution workflow

This should be the standard operating process for every paid campaign.

| #  | Stage               | Details                                                                   |
|----|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | Business pays       | Confirm payment, package, timeline and owner.                             |
| 2  | Campaign intake     | Collect product info, target audience, goal, CTA, offer and restrictions. |
| 3  | Brief writing       | Create a simple creator brief with hook ideas and exact do/dont rules.    |
| 4  | Creator selection   | Choose creators based on niche, city, audience, tier and availability.    |
| 5  | Creator acceptance  | Creators confirm rate, deadline, brief and posting rules.                 |
| 6  | Draft submission    | Creators submit draft videos before posting.                              |
| 7  | Review and revision | TrendStack checks brief compliance and brand approves or requests edits.  |
| 8  | Posting             | Approved creators post in the agreed window.                              |
| 9  | Proof collection    | Collect links, screenshots, basic metrics and tracking evidence.          |
| 10 | Payout review       | Check completion, compliance and fraud signals before payment.            |
| 11 | Report and repeat   | Deliver final report and propose next campaign.                           |

## 5. Campaign brief template

A good brief prevents bad content, delays and customer disappointment.

| Brief section       | What to include                                                                      |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Campaign name       | Brand + product + campaign dates.                                                    |
| Objective           | Visibility, WhatsApp enquiries, bookings, sales, signups, event tickets, etc.        |
| Target audience     | Who the content should speak to: age, city, interest, buyer type.                    |
| Creator profile     | Niche, city, tone, platform and content format.                                      |
| Product details     | What the product/service is, price/offer, availability and brand story.              |
| Content angle ideas | Unboxing, review, tutorial, visit, styling, routine, challenge, customer experience. |
| Required CTA        | WhatsApp link, coupon code, booking link, page follow, app download, ticket link.    |
| Do and do not       | Approved claims, banned claims, brand tone, words to avoid, content restrictions.    |
| Timeline            | Draft deadline, approval window, posting window, reporting date.                     |
| Proof required      | Post link, screenshots, analytics, coupon usage or lead evidence.                    |

## 6. Content review checklist

Content review is one of TrendStacks strongest advantages. Use it as a trust layer.

- ☐ Does the content follow the campaign objective?
- ☐ Does it mention or show the product/service correctly?
- ☐ Is the CTA clear and correct?
- ☐ Are any claims exaggerated, risky, medical, financial, or unsupported?
- ☐ Is the creator tone natural and not obviously scripted?
- ☐ Is video quality good enough: lighting, sound, framing and caption readability?
- ☐ Does the content fit the creator profile and audience?
- ☐ Is the brand name, price, location, offer or code correct?
- ☐ Does the content avoid competitor mentions or banned topics?
- ☐ Is the post safe for the brand to approve?

### Review outcome

Every draft should be marked Approved, Needs Revision or Rejected. Record the reason in the campaign tracker.

## 7. Payout and fraud-control model

The payout model should reward delivery without inviting fake views.

| Component                 | Meaning                                                                                            | Rule                                 |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| Base content fee          | Paid for approved draft/content creation.                                                          | Use for all creators.                |
| Posting fee               | Paid after approved post stays live for agreed period and proof is submitted.                      | Use for all creators.                |
| Capped bonus              | Small bonus for verified outcomes such as sales, valid leads, coupon usage or trusted performance. | Only Verified/Trusted creators.      |
| No unlimited view payouts | Raw views alone should not control earnings.                                                       | Protects budget and honest creators. |
| Payout hold               | Delay payment when metrics are suspicious, proof is missing or brief was violated.                 | Manual review required.              |

**Fraud signals:** sudden unnatural view spikes, comments from unrelated accounts, engagement that does not match view count, repeated creator excuses, missing screenshots, post deletion, or metrics that do not match platform behavior.



## 8. Campaign tracking dashboard

Use one campaign sheet to track every creator and every deliverable.

| Field 1      | Field 2           | Field 3       | Field 4                 | Field 5          | Field 6        |
|--------------|-------------------|---------------|-------------------------|------------------|----------------|
| Creator name | Tier              | Niche         | City                    | Rate             | Status         |
| Brief sent?  | Accepted?         | Draft due     | Draft link              | Review status    | Revision notes |
| Post date    | Post link         | Views         | Likes/comments /shares  | CTA clicks/codes | Payout status  |
| Fraud risk   | Business feedback | Creator score | Next campaign eligible? | Notes            | Owner          |

**Dashboard rule**

If it is not in the tracker, it did not happen. This protects TrendStack when businesses or creators dispute work.

## 9. Final report template

The report is how TrendStack earns trust and sells the next campaign.

| Report section         | What it should show                                                                                |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Campaign summary    | Business, objective, dates, package, creator count and campaign CTA.                               |
| 2. Creator delivery    | Creators invited, accepted, submitted, approved and posted.                                        |
| 3. Content links       | All post links, content thumbnails or screenshots, and approval status.                            |
| 4. Performance metrics | Views, likes, comments, shares, saves, profile visits where available.                             |
| 5. Business signals    | WhatsApp clicks, coupon usage, bookings, sales, signups or customer-reported outcomes.             |
| 6. Best content        | Top creator, top video, top hook, best comments and reusable content.                              |
| 7. Problems and fixes  | Creators removed, delays, content issues, fraud checks, what was corrected.                        |
| 8. Recommendation      | What to do next: repeat, change vertical, change hook, boost content or run a bigger/smaller wave. |

**Repeat sale line:** "Based on this campaign, the next best move is [specific recommendation]. We can run the next wave with [creator type/content angle] in [timeframe]."

# 10. What to automate later

Only build software for repeated pain that has already been proven manually.

| Potential feature     | Build only when...                                                          |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Creator database      | When you have 50+ active vetted creators and matching is becoming slow.     |
| Campaign tracker      | When 5+ campaigns are running and manual status updates create mistakes.    |
| Content review portal | When WhatsApp/Drive submissions become hard to manage.                      |
| Payout workflow       | When creator payout reconciliation is taking too much time.                 |
| Report generator      | When reports follow a stable format and take too long to prepare manually.  |
| Fraud scoring         | Only after you have enough campaign data to understand real fraud patterns. |

**Software principle**

Software should support a proven operation. It should not be used to hide uncertain demand, unclear pricing or weak repeat business.